

Dr. Timea Szarvas

LINGUIST

University of Potsdam, Karl-Liebknecht-Str. 24-25, 14469 Potsdam Germany

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Education

University of Potsdam

PHD IN LINGUISTICS (*magna cum laude*)

- Advisors: Prof. Dr. Doreen Georgi, Prof. Dr. Malte Zimmermann
- Reviewers: Prof. Dr. Doreen Georgi, Prof. Dr. Shota Momma

Potsdam, Germany

07/2021 - 12/2025

University of Massachusetts Amherst

VISITING SCHOLAR

- Hosts: Prof. Dr. Rhajesh Bhatt, Prof. Dr. Kyle Johnson
- Coursework in syntax, phonology and psycholinguistics.

Amherst, MA, USA

04/2025

University of Potsdam

MSC IN LINGUISTICS (*with distinction*)

- Advisors: Prof. Dr. Malte Zimmermann, Dr. Andreas Pregla

Potsdam, Germany

10/2018 - 06/2021

Eberhard Karls University

BA IN GERMAN AS A SECOND LANGUAGE

- Minor in General linguistics
- Advisor: Dr. Benjamin Siegmund

Tübingen, Germany

10/2015 - 08/2018

Positions held

- 2026-now **Postdoctoral researcher**, University of Potsdam, CRC 1287
- 2026-now **Equal opportunity officer**, University of Potsdam, CRC 1287
- 2021-2025 **Predoctoral researcher**, University of Potsdam, CRC 1287
- 2020-2021 **Research assistant**, University of Potsdam
- 2019-2020 **Research assistant**, Leibniz Zentrum Allgemeine Sprachwissenschaft Berlin
- 2016-2018 **Research assistant**, Eberhard Karls University

Publications

THESES

- Szarvas, Timea. 2025.** Rethinking principle C reconstruction in ATB and parasitic gaps: Data-driven perspectives on the too many tools problem. Doctoral thesis, University of Potsdam, <https://doi.org/10.25932/publishup-70250>.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2021.** Case and Agreement in Turkish nonsubject relative clauses: An experimental approach. Master thesis, University of Potsdam.

PEER REVIEWED

- Szarvas, Timea, Martin Salzmann, Stanislaw Zompì, Rebecca Jarvis, Mariia Privizentseva, Aron Finholt, Andreas Pregla, Doreen Georgi. Under revision.** Reconstruction for variable binding in ATB movement. Interpretive possibilities and their theoretical implications.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2025.** Why we're still debating principle C reconstruction. A comparative experimental study. In: *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 10(1): 1-42. doi: <https://doi.org/10.16995/glossa.18707>

PROCEEDINGS

- Georgi, Doreen, Andrew Murphy, Johannes Rothert & Timea Szarvas. 2025.** Diagnosing syntactic structure in ATB and RNR constructions: A reply to Larson (2013, 2014). In: Chen, X., Karakaş, S. & Shim, J. (eds.): *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society*, p. 173-188.

- Szarvas, Timea. 2025.** An asymmetry without theoretical consequences: Revisiting principle C reconstruction in ATB movement experimentally. In: Demiray, D., Liu, R. C., & Segal, N. (eds.): *Proceedings of the 55th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society*, Vol. 2, p. 239-248. University of Massachusetts, Amherst: GLSA.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** On reconstruction in German ATB-movement and the optimization of experimental designs. In: Sgrizzi, T., Shahbazi, A. & Tamleh, H. (eds): *Proceedings of the 32nd Conference of the Student Organization of Linguistics in Europe*, Leiden Centre of Linguistics.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** Unscrambling German parasitic gaps. In: Alexiadou, A., Georgi, D., Heck, F., Müller, G. & Schäfer, F. (eds): *Proceedings of the workshop on Gisbert Fanselow's contributions to syntactic theory*, Linguistische Arbeitsberichte (LAB) 96, University of Leipzig.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2022.** Scope ambiguities among suffixes in Hungarian: mood and modality at LF. In: Holtz, A., Kovač, I. & Puggaard-Rode, R. (eds): *Proceedings of the 30th Conference of the Student Organization of Linguistics in Europe*, p. 102–124. Leiden Centre of Linguistics.

Presentations

INVITED TALKS

- Fall 2025. *The limits of principle C reconstruction in ATB and parasitic gaps*. Invited talk: Theoretical Linguistics Colloquium, University of Vienna, Austria.
- Summer 2025. *Debunking the myth of principle C reconstruction in ATB and parasitic gaps*. Invited Talk, Linguistics Colloquium, University of Bielefeld, Germany.
- Spring 2025. *ATB = parasitic gaps? Considering inter-individual variability and the limits of principle C reconstruction*. Invited talk: Syntax Workshop, University of Massachusetts Amherst, USA.

PRESENTATIONS WITH PEER REVIEWED ABSTRACT

- Szarvas, Timea & Johannes Hein. 2026.** On right node raising in Hungarian: A Pruning approach. Oral presentation: Rightward Movement workshop, University College London, UK.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** PP modifiers do not reconstruct for principle C. Evidence from German wh- and ATB-movement. Poster: 55th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistic Society, Yale University, CT, USA.
- Georgi, Doreen, Andrew Murphy, Johannes Rothert & Timea Szarvas. 2024.** Find the gap: Diagnosing syntactic structure in ATB and RNR constructions. Oral presentation: 60th Annual Meeting of the Chicago Linguistic Society, University of Chicago, IL, USA.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** Experimenting with principle C in German ATB movement. Poster: Linguistic Evidence, University of Potsdam, Germany.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** On reconstruction in German ATB movement and the optimization of experimental designs. Oral presentation: 32nd Conference of the Student Organization of Linguistics in Europe, Queen Mary University of London, UK.
- Bade, Nadine, Abigail Bimpeh, Jeanne Lecavelier & Timea Szarvas. 2023.** On the markedness of number features in embedded free relative questions in Akan. Poster: 54th Annual Conference on African Linguistics, University of Connecticut, CT, USA.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2022.** Scope ambiguities among suffixes in Hungarian: Mood and modality. Oral presentation: 30th Conference of the Student Organization of Linguistics in Europe, University of Nantes, France.
- Szarvas, Timea & Johannes Rothert. 2020.** Challenges for theories of (post-)syntactic head movement: Tense and modality in Hungarian. Poster: 13th Conference on Syntax, Phonology and Language Analysis, Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest, Hungary.

OTHER

- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** PP modifiers do not reconstruct for principle C. Evidence from German wh- and ATB-movement. Poster: CRC network meeting, University of Cologne, Germany.
- Szarvas, Timea. 2024.** On the unreliability of the principle C reconstruction test. Poster: DGfS summer school, University of Göttingen, Germany.

Szarvas, Timea. 2023. Unscrambling German parasitic gaps. Poster: Workshop on Gisbert Fanselow's Contributions to Syntactic Theory, Humboldt University Berlin, Germany.

Szarvas, Timea. 2022. All that glitters is not syntax. On the deceptive comfort of the armchair. Oral presentation: 9th Linguistics Meetup Berlin-Brandenburg, University of Potsdam, Germany.

Teaching Experience

2026 Scientific problem solving for linguists, co-lecturer (w/ Magdalena Lohninger)	<i>OVA summer school</i>
2026 Intro to syntax I, lecturer	<i>OVA summer school</i>
2024-25 Experimental syntax (BA), lecturer	<i>University of Potsdam</i>

Outreach & Professional Development

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

2026 38th Comparative Germanic Syntax Workshop, organizing member	<i>University of Potsdam</i>
2026 German Linguistics Association (DGfS), program committee member	<i>University of Jena</i>
2021-2025 Collaborative research center 1287, PhD representative	<i>University of Potsdam</i>
2023 UMLV summer school, organizing member	<i>University of Potsdam</i>
2022 Potsdam Science Fair, presenter	<i>Potsdam</i>

DEVELOPMENT (SELECTED)

Seeing the invisible – understanding unconscious bias. Workshop, fall 2025, University of Potsdam, Germany.

Proposal writing. How to create promising grant applications. Workshop, fall 2024, University of Potsdam, Germany.

DGfS summer school, 2024, University of Göttingen, Germany.

CreteLing summer school, 2023, University of Crete, Greece.

Leadership skills for female researchers. Workshop, fall 2022, University of Potsdam, Germany.

6th summer school on Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology, 2022, University of Potsdam, Germany.

5th summer school on Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology, 2021, University of Potsdam, Germany.

PEER REVIEW

Natural Language and Linguistic Theory (2026)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

German Linguistics Association (DGfS)

Miscellaneous

LANGUAGES

- German (native)
- Hungarian (native)
- English (fluent)
- Bosnian-Croatian-Montenegrin-Serbian (basic)
- Latin (basically gone)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- R (proficient)
- Python (familiar)
- JavaScript (novice)